Nathan Rosenthal

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MS Economics | Causal Inference

Economics M.S. graduate who evaluates the impact of policies, shocks and programs using causal inference, turning complex data into clear, decision-ready insights. Experience building original datasets from public sources, applying econometric methods in Stata and R, and communicating technical findings to non-technical audiences. Focus areas include crime, education, and health economics.

Education

San Diego State University, San Diego 2024–2026
M.S., Economics, GPA 3.71

San Diego State University, San Diego 2022–2024
B.A., Economics with Distinction

De Anza College, Cupertino 2020–2021
A.A., Economics, Magna Cum Laude

Experience

Graduate Assistant – San Diego State University**,** San Diego 2024–2026

- Conducted rigorous quantitative research for multiple SDSU Economics faculty, contributing to study design, literature reviews, and the application of causal inference to real-world policy questions.
- Constructed and harmonized massive longitudinal datasets, including merging 20+ years of Brazilian electoral and development data; 20+ years of the national Health and Retirement Study (HRS) with supplemental datasets.
- Built proprietary datasets for faculty projects, web scraping in R where appropriate.
- Produce publication-quality tables and figures in Stata and R formatted for Word and LaTeX
- Deliver instructional support and mentor undergraduate students in *Intro to Econometrics* and *Principles of Economics*.

Undergraduate Assistant – San Diego State University **–** Center for Health Economics & Policy Studies (CHEPS), San Diego 2024

- Identified, cleaned and prepared datasets in Stata for various research projects including extensive primary data collection.
- Conducted independent research on the disparities in social security and assistance program take-up between heterosexual and non-heterosexual coupled individuals.

Sales Supervisor – Warby Parker, San Diego 2023

- Managed shifts of 3-8 employees in a fast-paced HIPAA compliant sales environment, actively selling on the floor and shadowing team members to offer real-time coaching.
- Mastered optical prescriptions and took precise PD measurements to guide customers on the best products.
- Trained new hires and mentored existing ones, including guiding a talented new hire through a successful sustainability glasses-donation campaign.

Apprentice (acting GM) & Service Manager – Chipotle Mexican Grill, San Jose 2018–2020

- Took control of a struggling, understaffed $3M+ annual high-volume location run by junior managers; audited the P&L to eliminate waste, rebuilt the team by replacing low performers, and raised internal KPIs from an "F" to a "B" grade within months.
- Mastered and taught knife skills and food safety best practices, achieving 90%+ scores on third party audits while training staff to maximize speed and throughput during high-volume rushes.
- Managed shifts and daily store operations as a Service Manager before stepping up as an Apprentice, overseeing inventories, truck orders, and performance reporting for leadership.

Research Projects

"The Contemporaneous Effects of School Funding on Crime: Evidence from California's Local Control Funding Formula" (Thesis) 2026

- Causal reductions in youth crime from targeted needs-based funding, leveraging differences in funding between high and low need counties via statewide school finance reform.

"*The Effects of Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza on Chicken and Turkey Prices*" 2025

- Reduced effects of HPAI outbreaks on prices poultry product prices from 2022-2025, accounting for biological lags in production and COVID-19 controls, using TWFE model via OLS

"*Disparities in Social Security and Medicaid Program Participation among Same-sex vs Different-sex Couples: Evidence from COVID-19 Pandemic Shocks*" 2025

- Poster presentation, S3 Symposium. Provost Award

Relevant Coursework

Applied Research in Econometrics – Grade: A 2025

- "Toolkit" class learning and applying causal inference methods and fixed effects to real world datasets, including difference in differences, event study, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity designs, synthetic control matching and propensity score matching, with panel data.

Statistical Machine Learning – Grade: A- 2025

- Applied machine learning models for prediction and classification in R
- Project: "The Lasting Effects of Redlining", examining how effectively historical redlining maps can predict present day neighborhood demographics with different ML models.

Enterprise Database Management – Grade: A

- Database management technologies to host, secure and manipulate enterprise data, information and knowledge assets to create business value. Modeling tools for analyzing and specifying data requirements.
- SQL proficiency

Awards & Scholarships

Provost's Award (S3 Symposium) 2025
Elynor F. McPeak Endowed Scholarship for Economics Excellence 2025
McCuen Endowed Economics Scholarship 2024 - 2025
CHEPS-ECON Social Insurance Research Fellowship 2024
Student Undergrad Research Program (SURP) & MUSE Award 2024

Skills

STATA – R – LaTeX – Arc GIS – SQL – Excel